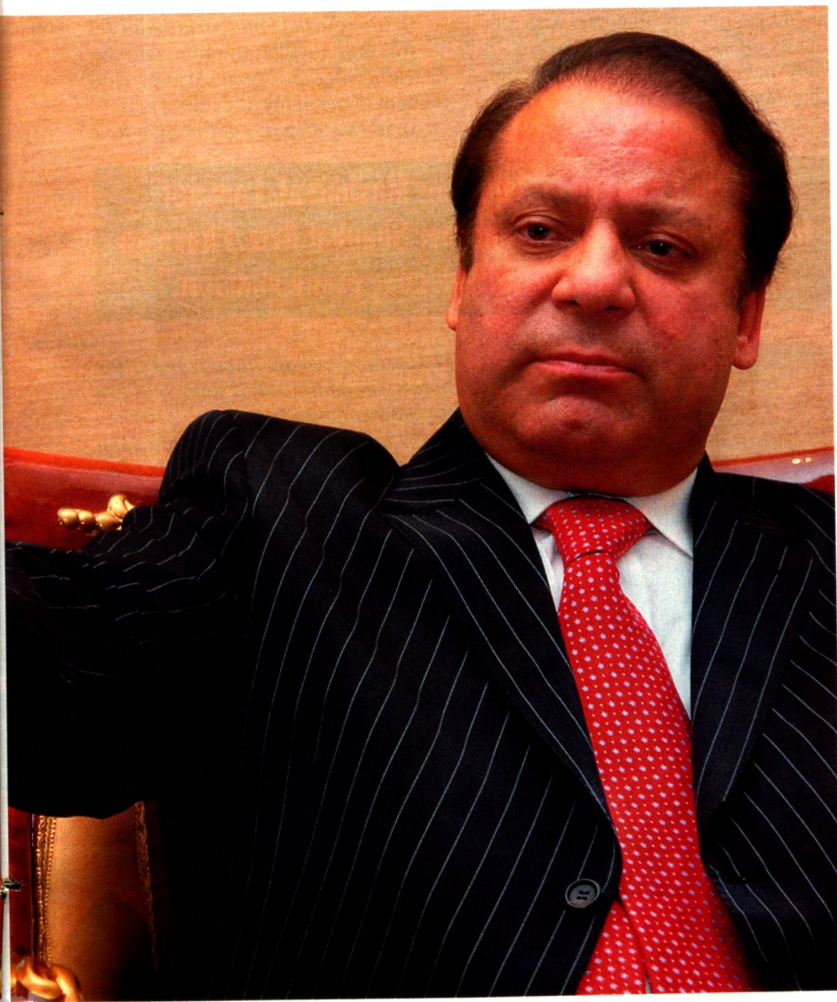


AF'S DUMMY"



And then he threw you out.

A. He is someone who can never be trusted. He said he would retire as army general before December 31, 2004. He has never fulfilled that commitment.

Q. As a General, he kept you, the elected prime minister, in the dark about the Kargil War.

A. He let me and my government down. He stabbed me in the back. I cut a sorry figure before Indian prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.

Q. So you did not know he was planning the attacks?

A. Not all the details.

Q. Do you mean he never shared anything with you?

A. No, not in the manner that should have been.

Q. Was the ceasefire due to American pressure? Or did you realise something had gone wrong?

A. I was never in favour of a war with India. The Indian prime minister had undertaken a state visit to Pakistan only a few months earlier. I have great regards for Vajpayee. I never wanted to let him down. And this man here committed a blunder and embarrassed me.

Q. You announced ceasefire only after going to America. Can you tell us what happened there?

A. I had a three-hour-long meeting with president Bill Clinton. Then he called up Vajpayee in the middle of the night. We felt the conflict in Kargil could lead to a full-fledged war between the two countries which could ultimately turn into a nuclear conflict. We did our best. We are also thankful to Vajpayee for his cooperation which made the ceasefire possible.

Q. As prime minister in the early 1990s, you ushered in economic liber-

terrorism at home.

A. I think he created the issue of the Lal Masjid himself. What was he doing for the past six months? Why did he allow ammunition build-up inside the masjid?

Q. What will he gain by creating this kind of monster?

A. He's hoodwinking the West. Dictatorship serves as a breeding ground for extremism and terrorism. Such things never surface in a democracy.

Q. You colluded with the dictator and got out of the country.

"Musharraf let me down. He stabbed me in the back. I cut a sorry figure before Atal Bihari Vajpayee and that's why I was very keen on bringing about an honourable ceasefire."

A. I never compromised on principles. I had to take action against a chief of army staff General Jehangir Karamat who was a very good man. But he gave a political statement which forced me to act against him.

Q. Musharraf was your appointee.

alisation in your country.

A. Yes, I recall your then prime minister Narasimha Rao had spoken to me personally and had said he wanted to send a team across to study our reforms process. We also launched a privatisation programme in Pakistan. Many